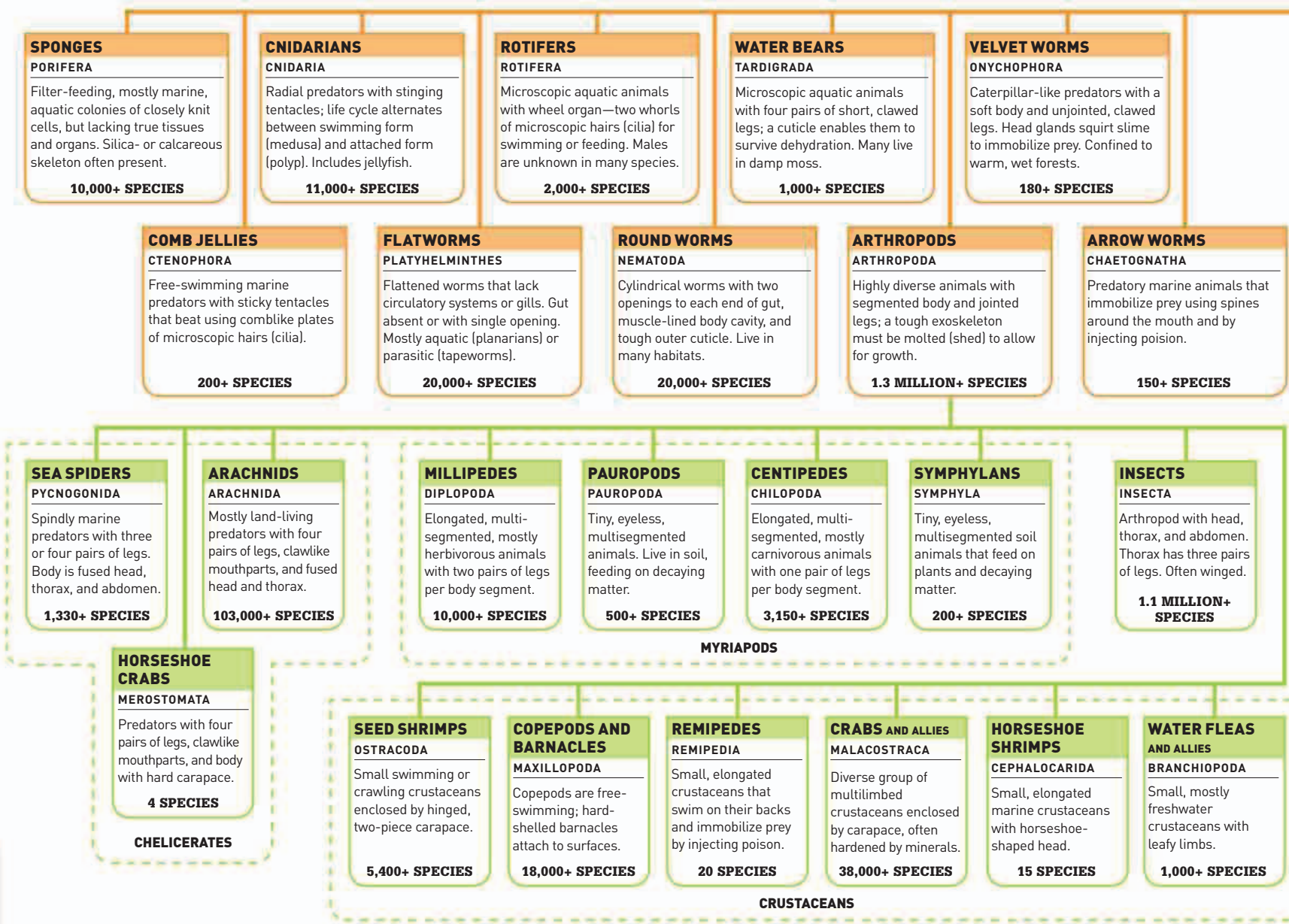


ANIMALS

Animals are grouped into phyla according to the internal arrangement of their organs and body cavities. The simplest bodies have a single opening to the gut and even lack blood circulatory systems. In more advanced animals, the body has organs for respiration and excretion, as well as a sophisticated brain. Most animals

reproduce sexually by producing eggs and swimming sperm, but some are asexual. More than 90 percent of animals in over 30 phyla are invertebrates—animals that lack a backbone. All vertebrates (including humans) belong to the single phylum Chordata, but even this phylum includes some invertebrates.



HUMAN ANCESTORS

Humans—members of the genus *Homo*—appeared on Earth within the last 2 million years, having descended from a group of apelike ancestors that included the genera *Paranthropus* and *Australopithecus*. Several different species of *Homo*, such as *Homo neanderthalensis*, have lived in recent times, but only a single species—*Homo sapiens*—survives today. All humans and apes belong to the family Hominidae in the mammal order Primates.

